Launch Control XL 3 — House Keys Lab 14 (lab/keys, round 14 for 009: sound and warmth)

Touch as decided (brighter accent before gaps, 2nd rhythm soft) on every column. Each column changes the sound one way; shift + the column's fader = how much (0 = none: all columns alike, the comparison). Start: half. All columns equally loud at half.

1 sampler grit (kept from round 13). 2 the same grit, darker. 3 felt piano: soft hammer, dark, slow attack. 4 tube: warm saturation. 5 body: the lowest note an octave lower, soft. 6 filter pluck: each hit opens and closes the filter. 7 analog stab: detuned saws under the keys. 8 vowel filter: hollow “o” colour.

Sound: hold any column's button 2 and turn its knobs: 1 = piano → Rhodes, 2 = B3 → M1, 3 = vibraphone → marimba. In Mode 2: faders 1-4 = grand, Rhodes, organ, vibraphone layers; knob 3 above each changes its character; faders 6 and 7 = drums and bass.

Knob | Fader | Button | unused

Mode 16 — Rhythms

	1 Sampler grit	2 Grit, darker	3 Felt piano	4 Tube	5 Body below	6 Filter pluck	7 Analog stab	8 Vowel filter
Row 1 Brightness	CC 13 **Brightness** dull ↔ bright (lpf 250 Hz – 12 kHz, a little resonance): the filter sweep; brighter also plays a little harder (±2 dB, a softer attack at the dark end).	CC 14 **Brightness** as 1 Sampler grit	CC 15 **Brightness** as 1 Sampler grit	CC 16 **Brightness** as 1 Sampler grit	CC 17 **Brightness** as 1 Sampler grit	CC 18 **Brightness** as 1 Sampler grit	CC 19 **Brightness** as 1 Sampler grit	CC 20 **Brightness** as 1 Sampler grit
Row 2 Space	CC 21 **Space** 0 = dry; a 1/8 echo is there from the first turn (full at half), from about a third on the room joins (full at the top).	CC 22 **Space** as 1 Sampler grit	CC 23 **Space** as 1 Sampler grit	CC 24 **Space** as 1 Sampler grit	CC 25 **Space** as 1 Sampler grit	CC 26 **Space** as 1 Sampler grit	CC 27 **Space** as 1 Sampler grit	CC 28 **Space** as 1 Sampler grit
Row 3 Length	CC 29 **Length** 0 = short stab ↔ hits ring four times longer.	CC 30 **Length** as 1 Sampler grit	CC 31 **Length** as 1 Sampler grit	CC 32 **Length** as 1 Sampler grit	CC 33 **Length** as 1 Sampler grit	CC 34 **Length** as 1 Sampler grit	CC 35 **Length** as 1 Sampler grit	CC 36 **Length** as 1 Sampler grit
Fader Level	CC 5 **Level** sampler grit: fewer bits, lower sample rate (90s sampler).	CC 6 **Level** grit, darker: the same grit, the top end rolled off.	CC 7 **Level** felt piano: soft hammer, much darker, slower attack, rings longer.	CC 8 **Level** tube: warm saturation, the top a little softer.	CC 9 **Level** body below: the lowest note an octave lower on a soft triangle.	CC 10 **Level** filter pluck: each hit opens the filter and closes it quickly.	CC 11 **Level** analog stab: two detuned saws per note, filtered, under the keys.	CC 12 **Level** vowel filter: a parallel copy through an “o” formant filter.
Button 1 Change	CC 37 **Change** 8 patterns: chain → shifted chain → pairs → 3-3-2 → Kerri syncope → Kerri riff → chain + shifted chain → chain + pairs.	CC 38 **Change** as 1 Sampler grit	CC 39 **Change** as 1 Sampler grit	CC 40 **Change** as 1 Sampler grit	CC 41 **Change** as 1 Sampler grit	CC 42 **Change** as 1 Sampler grit	CC 43 **Change** as 1 Sampler grit	CC 44 **Change** as 1 Sampler grit
Button 2 Shift	CC 45 **Shift** press = on / off: the 3 knobs mix the sound (piano → Rhodes, B3 → M1, vibraphone → marimba); the fader = how much of the column's sound idea (0 = none).	CC 46 **Shift** as 1 Sampler grit	CC 47 **Shift** as 1 Sampler grit	CC 48 **Shift** as 1 Sampler grit	CC 49 **Shift** as 1 Sampler grit	CC 50 **Shift** as 1 Sampler grit	CC 51 **Shift** as 1 Sampler grit	CC 52 **Shift** as 1 Sampler grit

Mode 2 — Sound + global

	1 Grand	2 Rhodes	3 Organ	4 Vibraphone	5	6 Drums	7 Bass	8
Row 1	CC 61 —	CC 62 —	CC 63 —	CC 64 —	CC 65 —	CC 66 **Swing** 50 % straight ↔ 70 %; 55–58 % = house.	CC 67 —	CC 68 —
Row 2	CC 69 —	CC 70 —	CC 71 —	CC 72 —	CC 73 —	CC 74 —	CC 75 —	CC 76 —
Row 3	CC 77 **M1** 0 = plain grand ↔ the 90s house piano (detuned, e-piano octave, a little grit).	CC 78 **Phaser** 0 = plain ↔ slow, deep phaser swirl.	CC 79 **M1** 0 = B3 ↔ M1, blended at equal loudness.	CC 80 **Marimba** 0 = vibraphone ↔ woody marimba, blended at equal loudness.	CC 81 —	CC 82 —	CC 83 —	CC 84 —
Fader Level	CC 53 **Grand** layer level: dry grand piano.	CC 54 **Rhodes** layer level: warm electric piano.	CC 55 **Organ** layer level: B3 and M1 organ.	CC 56 **Vibraphone** layer level: soft, jazzy mallets.	CC 57 —	CC 58 **Drums** 909 kick, off-beat hat, clap, shaker.	CC 59 **Bass** off-beat bass on the chord root.	CC 60 —
Buttons 1	CC 85 —	CC 86 —	CC 87 —	CC 88 —	CC 89 —	CC 90 —	CC 91 —	CC 92 —
Buttons 2	CC 93 —	CC 94 —	CC 95 —	CC 96 —	CC 97 —	CC 98 **Drums out** keys and bass alone while held.	CC 99 —	CC 100 —

Guide

What to listen for

Against the 0-fader (all alike): is it warmer, does it have more character, without getting muddy or harsh on top? Try it with piano and with Rhodes (shift + knob 1). Note per column: keep / drop and the fader position you like.

Why off the kick

Stab rhythms that avoid the kick and sit on the off-16ths pull against the beat; hits on the kick double it and sound like a band. Two hits and 3-3-2 do start on the one: that is their weight.

Harmony

One chord only: Am9 in Kerri Chandler's shape (the 7th at the bottom, the 9 instead of the root). Chord changes have their own board: house-harmony-lab.